to potential conflicts in East Asia. It is no secret that India's most pressing challenges in the coming decades will be domestic, particularly in the realm of sustainable economic growth. India's demographic bulge is both an opportunity and a threat, contingent on the government's ability to create the necessary infrastructure to manage service provision and the necessary policy environment that will encourage economic growth and job creation in the long term. While India has been successful in lifting millions of individuals out of poverty since the early 1990s, the nature of its economic growth has unleashed a range of environmental hazards ranging from depleting water tables to severe air pollution in urban centres such as New Delhi. Given the challenges of a labour- and resource-intensive growth model, India finds an ideal partner in Japan, a country with a capital-intensive and high-technology approach to economic growth.[23] No country in Asia is better placed in terms of using technology and capital to address the challenges of human resource development alongside the growth of urbanisation and transportation and communication networks. The transfer and sale of technologies and industrial knowhow from Japan to India in a range of applications ranging from road construction to clean energy is likely to go a long way in helping New Delhi manage some of its most pressing domestic challenges in years to come. In doing so, Japan would essentially help build the sinews of power that will take India further along the path to global influence.

The Japanese government has gone to great lengths to provide incentives to Japanese firms to invest in India, and the results are evident: in the 2000–2018 period, Japan's share of foreign direct investment (FDI) in India was 7 percent, behind only Mauritius (32 percent) and Singapore (19 percent).[24] India has been the single largest recipient of Japanese official development assistance (ODA) since 2003–